

KYLE GAARDER

Growth Product Manager | Demand Generation | Retention

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SUMMARY

Growth-minded builder with proven demand generation and retention results. Built a 3,140-subscriber pipeline from zero through grassroots outreach, and maintained 94% occupancy for 19 months through community-driven retention. I specialize in turning early-stage products into sustainable growth engines using experimentation, user research, and engagement loops.

EXPERIENCE

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX

- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching 100% occupancy before lease start
- Built retention engine that sustained 94% occupancy for 19 months through community programming
- Designed onboarding and activation loops converting new users into long-term engaged residents
- Ran 48 community dinners, 4 mastermind cohorts, and 6 work-trade programs driving engagement
- Executed A/B testing on dynamic pricing and stay-length diversification, driving 48% revenue lift at 94% occupancy
- Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY through growth-focused iteration
- Built user insights engine via interviews and events, turning patterns into growth recommendations

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR

- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots outreach and concept validation
- Conducted 48 customer interviews to guide product-market fit and growth strategy
- Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
- Led cross-functional growth execution across strategy, ops, and product in startup environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA

- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
- Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
- Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
- Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
- Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 💎 **3,140-Sub Demand Pipeline**
Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers from zero through grassroots outreach
- 💎 **94% Retention for 19 Months**
Community-driven retention engine sustained 94% occupancy for 19 consecutive months
- 💎 **48% Revenue via Experiments**
A/B tested pricing and engagement programs driving 48% annual revenue growth
- 💎 **Investor Pilot Secured**
Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community concept across 5 states
- 💎 **Rapid Product Launch**
Launched coliving product from concept to 100% occupancy in 2 weeks

SKILLS

- Growth Strategy
- Demand Generation
- Retention & Engagement
- A/B Testing & Experiments
- User Research Interviews
- Lifecycle & Nurture Loops
- Partnerships Market Creation

EDUCATION

Bachelors in Science, Biology

Virginia Tech

📅 08/2010 - 05/2014

📍 Virginia, USA

- Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish

GPA
3.5 / 4.0